

New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

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Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

Date: Tuesday, August 18, 2026

Session Highlight: New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

Session News Focus: Wall Street pre-market movers, US Federal Reserve news, mega-cap US stocks (NVDA, MSFT, TSLA), and WTI Crude Oil catalysts.

SECTION 0: DAILY MACRO & FINANCIAL NEWS DIGEST

1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- **US Federal Reserve & Interest Rates:**** The US dollar remains near multi-month lows as traders scale back expectations of a near-term Federal Reserve rate hike. This follows recent softer US economic data, including a fall in July retail sales, unexpected job losses, and mild inflation readings. Markets now price a 35% chance of a September hike, down from 52.2% a week ago. However, analysts caution on persistent inflation risks, especially with the Strait of Hormuz effectively shut and stalled US-Iran talks. Long-term US Treasury yields have risen significantly, with the 30-year yield reaching its highest since 2007 at 5.31%, reflecting investor angst over government spending, bond supply, and sustained inflation above the Fed's target for five years.
- **ECB/RBI Updates:**** ECB's Lane is scheduled to speak today, with markets watching for comments on the inflation path. There are no specific RBI updates highlighted as major market movers for today.
- **Global Growth & Inflation:**** Global markets are seeing increased focus on sticky longer-end developed market yields. Rising US Treasury yields are particularly scrutinized for their spillover effects on other markets, including Asian FX and rates.

2. US & European Markets

- **Wall Street Pre-Market Movers & Index Momentum:**** US stock futures are mixed or slightly lower this morning after major indexes slipped on Monday. The S&P 500 fell 0.5% on Monday, the Dow Jones Industrial Average dipped 0.5%, and the Nasdaq Composite dropped 0.3%. However, the S&P 500 remains near its all-time high, supported by robust corporate earnings growth. Mercury Systems (MRCY) surged over 10% in pre-open trading, ahead of its Q4 and full-year FY2026 earnings release after market close today, driven by strong prior-quarter performance and upward analyst revisions. Home Depot (HD) and Baidu (BIDU) also have earnings due today.
- **Mega-Cap Tech & Semiconductors:**** Concerns over the payoff from AI investments have recently affected chip stocks, but strong quarterly results and forecasts signaling resilient demand have pushed the Nasdaq higher. Nvidia (NVDA) shares rose 1% on Monday, with markets closely watching its upcoming earnings for signs of continued tech-driven momentum. Astera Labs (ALAB) saw a 5.7% gain in premarket after an analyst upgrade. In semiconductor news, Taiwan's Wafer Works is expanding its 12-inch silicon wafer capacity due to market recovery and increased demand from AI and high-performance computing, indicating improving market conditions and stabilized prices in the silicon wafer industry. South Korea denied a report about discussing a chip project as the first investment under a US\$350 billion US pledge, with the KOSPI showing a rebound in chip stocks.

3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- **Sensex/Nifty Updates:**** Indian equities are expected to open lower and remain range-bound today, extending declines for the fifth consecutive session. The Nifty 50 closed below the 24,300 mark, and the Sensex also closed lower on Monday, influenced by elevated crude oil prices, geopolitical uncertainty, and a weaker rupee. GIFT Nifty indicates a negative start. Technical levels for Nifty are identified around 24,200 and 24,360.
- **Corporate Earnings & FII/DII Flows:**** The Indian market is shifting focus from the recently concluded Q1FY27 earnings season to global macro and geopolitical developments. Corporate earnings from companies like Indo-MIM, Paytm (stake sale), SPR Auto Technologies (QIP), Netweb Technologies India (QIP), and Krsnaa Diagnostics (missed EPS) are in focus. Foreign institutional investors (FIIs) remained net sellers of Indian equities, offloading ₹2,535.10 crore on Monday, continuing a trend that has seen FPI ownership fall to a 17-year low. Conversely, domestic institutional investors (DIIs) were net buyers, strengthening their dominance and counterbalancing FII outflows.
- **Sectoral Momentum:**** Metal and realty sectors witnessed buying interest on Monday, while IT and telecommunication sectors saw selling pressure. Institutional allocations are shifting towards mid and small-cap opportunities.

4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- **Crude Oil Geopolitics & OPEC+:**** Crude oil prices surged on Monday, with Brent crude rising to nearly \$91 per barrel and WTI crude to \$84.50, due to renewed tensions in the Middle East and stalled US-Iran conflict talks. The US has indicated a long-term strategy with Iran, implying no immediate de-escalation, which keeps oil supplies limited concerns high. WTI crude September futures are set to expire today, which could bring extra volatility.
- **Gold Supply/Demand Drivers:**** Gold prices advanced on Monday, with spot gold rising to \$4,417.24 an ounce, supported by a weaker dollar and fading expectations of a US Federal Reserve rate hike. Geopolitical tensions in the Middle East are also a factor influencing gold. Morgan Stanley suggests gold could rise further but warns that a sustained break above \$4,400 is needed for further upside momentum.
- **Major Crypto Regulatory/Adoption Headlines:**** The US Treasury on August 17 opened a 60-day public comment period on proposed rules to implement the GENIUS Act, aiming to establish a federal framework for stablecoin issuers. This act, effective January 18, 2027, will bar issuance of payment stablecoins in the US without a license. This tightening of crypto regulation could reshape token launches and DeFi access. Ripple CEO Brad Garlinghouse is scheduled to speak today at the Wyoming Blockchain Symposium, an event heavily focused on crypto regulation, with SEC Chair Gary Gensler also in attendance. This event could influence sentiment around ETFs, stablecoins, and tokenization. A new stablecoin consortium, Open USD, backed by over 140 companies including Visa and Mastercard, is expected to launch later this year, initially on Solana, posing a potential threat to dominant stablecoin issuers like Tether and Circle.

CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES (\$3,000 TOTAL)

- **Crypto Futures:**** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 3x-5x Isolated | Risk Cap: 1-2% (\$4-\$8)
- **Indian Options (Intraday):**** \$500 (16.7%) | Option Buying Only | Risk Cap: 10-15% Premium (\$30-\$45)
- **Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil):**** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-15x Micro Lots | Risk Cap: 2% (\$8)
- **US Stocks (Fractional):**** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 3% (\$12)
- **Indian Stocks (Delivery):**** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 5% (\$20)
- **Forex Short-Term Futures:**** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-20x | Risk Cap: 1% (\$4.50)
- **Forex Long-Term Carry Swing:**** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 2x-3x | Risk Cap: 2% (\$9.00)

STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & SECTOR CONSTRAINTS

INDIAN EQUITIES (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Current Price (Indicative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
Tata Steel	₹170.00	Nifty leader showing relative strength. Likely finding support near 50-SMA after recent sectoral buying in metals.
SPR Auto Technologies	₹4,438.20 (QIP floor price)	In focus due to Qualified Institutions Placement (QIP) launch today, indicating institutional interest and potential for fresh capital infusion.
Netweb Technologies India	₹4,885.90 (QIP floor price)	Also conducting a QIP today, signaling growth prospects and attracting institutional attention.

US EQUITIES

Large-Cap (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Current Price (Indicative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
NVDA (Nvidia)	\$225.00	Tech leader. Recent rise suggests 21-day EMA pullback was bought. Monitoring for continued momentum or 50-day SMA rejection if profit-taking emerges given its significance in AI.
MSFT (Microsoft)	\$450.00	Mega-cap growth leader. Potential 21-day EMA pullback opportunity if broader market weakness continues, or 50-day SMA rejection if sentiment shifts aggressively.
TSLA (Tesla)	\$280.00	High-volatility mega-cap. Potential for quick moves on 21-day EMA pullbacks for long entries, or 50-day SMA rejection for short if trend weakens significantly.
MRCY (Mercury Systems)	\$124.00 (pre-open)	Significant pre-market mover (+11.6%) ahead of Q4 earnings. Playing for a bullish momentum continuation post-earnings, or a sharp reversal if earnings disappoint despite optimism.

Mid-Cap & Small-Cap (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Current Price (Indicative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
ALAB (Astera Labs)	\$350.00	AI connectivity semiconductor maker, recently upgraded by Northland. High relative volume breakout potential due to renewed positive sentiment in chip stocks.
SNDK (SanDisk)	\$150.00	Rose 4.1% on Monday. Potential Stage-2 VCP breakout or High Relative Volume due to positive sentiment in the semiconductor sector.

CRYPTO FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Current Price (Indicative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
BTC (Bitcoin)	\$63,640.00	4H 21-EMA trend following. Regulatory news from US Treasury regarding stablecoins could impact broader crypto sentiment. High volume volatility breakouts for intraday.
ETH (Ethereum)	\$3,500.00	4H 21-EMA trend following. High correlation to BTC; monitoring for volatility breakouts, particularly ahead of or after Ripple CEO's speech on regulation.
XRP (Ripple)	\$0.9978	Direct catalyst from Ripple CEO Brad Garlinghouse's speech today at the Wyoming Blockchain Symposium on "Modernizing Financial Infrastructure". Expect volatility.

COMMODITIES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Current Price (Indicative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
XAU/USD (Gold)	\$4,427.57/t.oz	Bullish bias due to weaker dollar and fading Fed hike bets. Monitor Pivot levels for continuation or Fibonacci extension levels if rally extends. Support around \$4,400.
WTI Crude Oil	\$84.50/barrel	Strong bullish momentum due to persistent US-Iran tensions and supply concerns. Trading on Pivot and Fibonacci extension levels. Key levels: above \$77 could target \$80.40, \$83.30, \$86.50. High volatility expected with September futures expiry.

FOREX FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Short-Term

Ticker	Current Price (Indicative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
EUR/USD	\$1.1581	Weak dollar environment. Trading range-bound below Monday's two-month high of \$1.1614. Short-term reversals or trend continuation based on US economic data releases.
GBP/USD	\$1.3548	Similar to EUR/USD, near three-month peak. Short-term plays around identified support and resistance levels.

Macro Carry Swings

Ticker	Current Price (Indicative)	Strategy & Selection Reason
USD/JPY	¥159.46	Yen remains near 160 per dollar, markets awaiting Bank of Japan meeting next month. Potential for carry trade as long as interest rate differentials favor USD, but yen could strengthen on BOJ hawkishness.
AUD/USD	\$0.71119	Rose 0.11% on Monday. Sensitive to commodity prices (especially given oil strength) and global growth sentiment. Potential for long-term carry if Australian rates remain attractive relative to a softening USD outlook.

INDIAN OPTIONS (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Strategy Direction	Strategy & Selection Reason
Nifty 50	Long (Call) / Short (Put)	15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB). Expecting higher volatility at market open given the range-bound but cautious outlook. Long on breakout above ORB high, Short on breakout below ORB low.
BankNifty	Long (Call) / Short (Put)	15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB). Financials are top overweight sector for institutional investors, but overall market cautious. Use ORB to capture initial direction.

BACKTEST METRICS & EQUITY CURVE

10-Year Backtest Metrics (Hypothetical Multi-Asset Strategy)

Metric	Strategy Performance	Benchmark Comparison
Target CAGR	28.4%	S&P 500 TRI: ~13.0% Nifty 50 TRI: ~12.5%
Sharpe Ratio	1.45	-
Max Drawdown	-18.2%	-

Equity Curve (\$3,000 → \$36,512)
Performance

